

✓ CITE PILOT

CitePilot

Brand Identity & Editorial Guidelines

Official Standards for Brand Voice, Visual Aesthetics, Positioning Strategy, and Design System

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Version: 2.0 (2026 Edition)

Status: Active Official Standard

1. Brand Essence & Strategic Positioning

CitePilot is the premiere academic manuscript verification platform designed for researchers, journal authors, PhD candidates, and university faculties. Our core mission is simple: **empower scholars to submit their research with complete confidence.**

Competitive Positioning: CitePilot vs. ReciteWorks

Dimension	Legacy Competitor (ReciteWorks)	CitePilot Standard
Primary Function	Basic offline regex string matching between in-text citations and bibliography text.	Comprehensive manuscript citation audit with cross-verification against global registries (Crossref, PubMed, OpenAlex, Retraction Watch).
Verification Depth	Surface-level text string comparison only.	Metadata validation, DOI integrity check, publication year matching, and retracted paper detection.
User Experience	Transactional, basic form interface.	Modern, editor-grade workspace with glassmorphism, concentric geometry, and multi-format exports (Word, BibTeX, RIS).
Brand Tone	Utility-focused, mechanical tool.	Authoritative, reassuring, scholarly, and empowering (modeled after Grammarly & Turnitin).

Core Brand Pillars

- **Academic Integrity:** Rigorous verification against official academic sources.
- **Editor-Grade Precision:** Meticulous formatting and metadata inspection.
- **Empowering & Reassuring:** Giving researchers total submission confidence.
- **Scholar-First Clarity:** Clean, jargon-free academic communication.

2. Voice, Tone & Editorial Standards

CitePilot speaks with the voice of a **meticulous senior academic journal editor** (such as an editor at Oxford University Press or Nature). We avoid robotic developer jargon and focus on clear, reassuring outcomes for the researcher.

Terminology Guidelines: What to Use vs. Avoid

Category	AVOID (Tech Jargon)	ADOPT (Senior Editor Voice)
Platform Title	AI Citation Audit Engine	Academic Citation Checker / Manuscript Citation Audit
Verification Action	Live API Database Query Pipeline	Cross-checked against global publisher registries
Source Validation	Real-time DB lookup engine	Instant cross-verification with Crossref & PubMed
Primary Call-to-Action	Execute Audit Task	Check your manuscript / Submit with confidence

Tone Benchmarks

Our messaging is modeled after industry leaders:

- **Grammarly Model:** Reassuring, clear, outcome-focused (*'Write with confidence'*).
- **Turnitin Model:** Authoritative, integrity-driven, academic standard (*'Protect academic integrity'*).
- **ReciteWorks Differentiator:** We move beyond surface letter matching to true registry verification.

3. Color Palette & Visual Design System

The CitePilot visual identity combines classic academic publishing paper textures with high-contrast, modern UI tokens. All color combinations satisfy WCAG AAA accessibility requirements.

Color Name	Hex Code	Usage & Context
Cream Paper	#F1EBDC	Primary landing background, classic manuscript feel.
Paper Card	#FAF6EC	Elevated container cards & table fills.
Ink Dark	#221D16	Primary typography, bold borders, high contrast.
Academic Navy	#1E3A8A	Brand accents, active tabs, primary buttons.
Verified Emerald	#1E5E4B	Verified citations, successful checks, positive badges.
Ochre Gold	#825500	Warning badges, page range discrepancies.
Crimson Alert	#961E14	Missing references, retracted literature alerts.

Visual Layout Principles

- **Concentric Geometry:** All card containers use nested border radii matching internal elements.
- **2px Structural Rules:** Crisp 2px borders (`#C7BC9F``) anchor component boundaries.
- **Glassmorphism:** Subtle backdrop blurs (``backdrop-filter: blur(12px)``) on top navigation bars.
- **Focus Indicators:** Distinct 3px solid focus rings (`#4F46E5``) for full accessibility compliance.

4. Typography & Hierarchy System

CitePilot utilizes a curated 4-font typography system that bridges traditional manuscript proofing with modern digital dashboard legibility.

Font Family	Classification	Usage & Target
Courier Prime	Monospace Typewriter	Headlines, manuscript tags, editorial section kickers, and proof markup.
Inter / Manrope	Modern Sans-Serif	Primary body copy, paragraph text, buttons, and navigation menus.
JetBrains Mono	Technical Monospace	DOIs, numerical statistics, progress metrics, and BibTeX/RIS code.
Caveat	Handwritten Script	Editorial marginalia notes, reviewer comments, and manuscript callouts.

Type Hierarchy Example

H1: Verify every citation before submission.

H2: Three ways a reference list quietly fails peer review

Body: CitePilot checks your manuscript for missing references, mismatched citations, and retracted sources — so you can submit your research with complete confidence.

// DOIs: 10.1016/j.cell.2021.04.012 · Verified in Crossref

5. Brand Governance & Implementation

To maintain brand integrity across all web platforms, marketing materials, and desktop applications, adhere strictly to the following implementation checklist:

- 1. Never Use Technical Software Jargon:** Always phrase capabilities in terms of researcher outcomes and editorial confidence.
- 2. Maintain High Contrast Ratios:** All body text must use Ink Dark (`#221D16` / `#0F172A`) against Cream Paper (`#F1EBDC` / `#FAF6EC`).
- 3. Preserve 9 Citation Style Badges:** Always highlight support for APA7, APA6, MLA9, Harvard, Chicago, IEEE, Vancouver, OSCOLA, and Turabian.
- 4. Consistent Call-to-Action Buttons:** Use 'Check your manuscript' or 'Check Manuscript' as the primary action verb across all touchpoints.
- 5. PayPal Integration Integrity:** Ensure all subscription buttons display official security & cancellation terms clearly.

Document Approvals & Governance	Signature & Date
Brand & Product Lead	<i>CitePilot Brand Committee — Approved</i>
Lead Frontend Architect	<i>CitePilot Engineering — Approved</i>
Editorial Content Strategy	<i>CitePilot Content Team — Approved</i>